Incident Response Report

Case ID: SOC326

Analyst	Ahmed Emad Nasr
Date	September 17, 2024
Severity	Medium
Verdict	True Positive

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1. Executive Summary

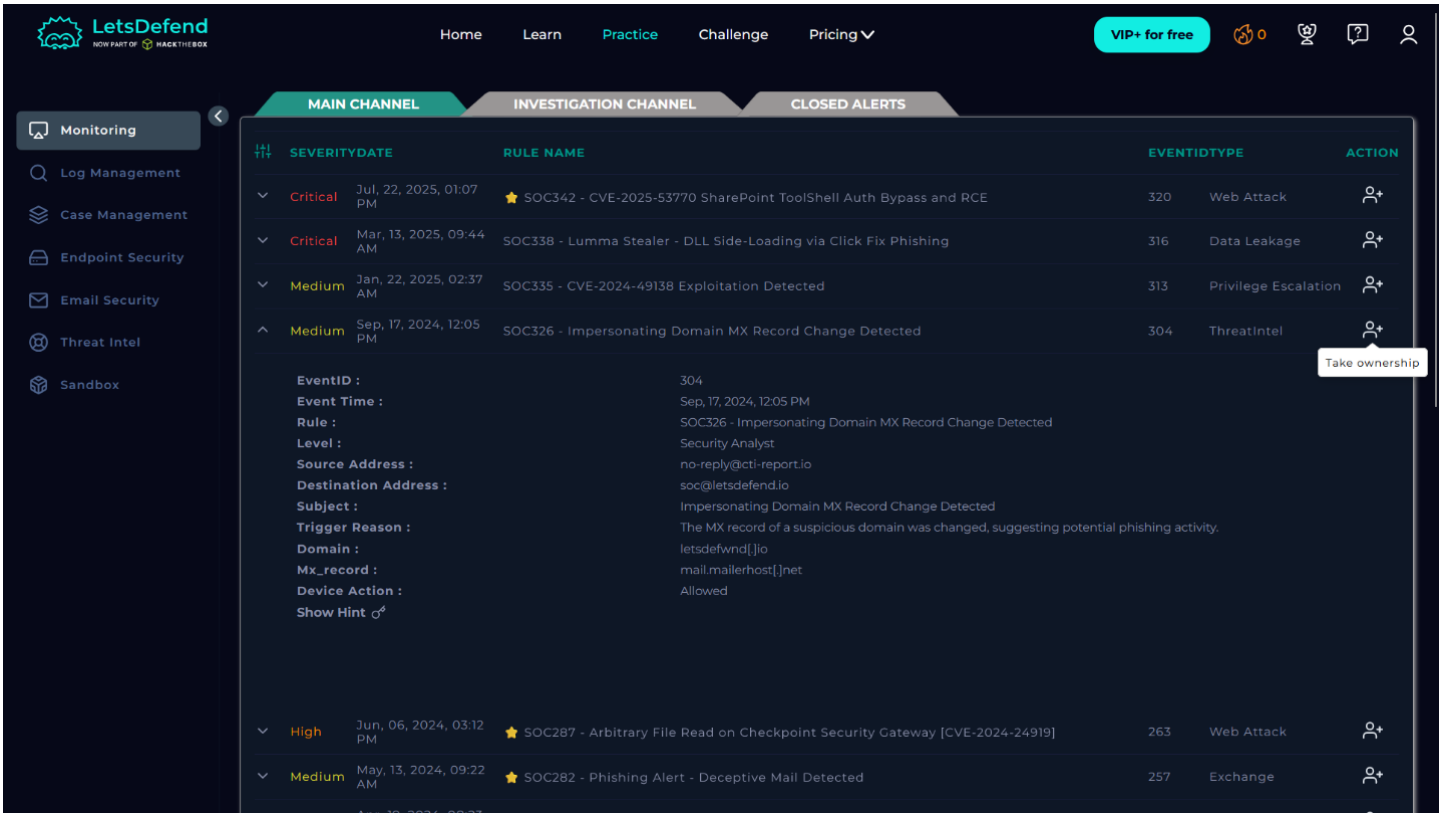
On September 17, 2024, at 12:05 PM, the SOC generated a Medium severity alert related to a suspicious MX record change for a typosquatted domain: letsdefwnd.io, impersonating the legitimate domain letsdefend.io.

Further investigation confirmed this activity as part of a targeted phishing campaign. The attacker successfully delivered a phishing email into the corporate environment, and an internal user (Hostname: Mateo) interacted with the malicious link.

Endpoint telemetry confirmed that the user accessed the phishing website and established an outbound connection to an attacker-controlled IP address.

Final Assessment: True Positive

Risk Level: Critical (Confirmed User Interaction & Potential Credential Compromise)



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2. Initial Alert Details

[General Information]

Rule Name: SOC326 - Impersonating Domain MX Record Change Detected

Event ID: 304

Timestamp: September 17, 2024 – 12:05 PM

Initial Severity: Medium

Event Type: ThreatIntel

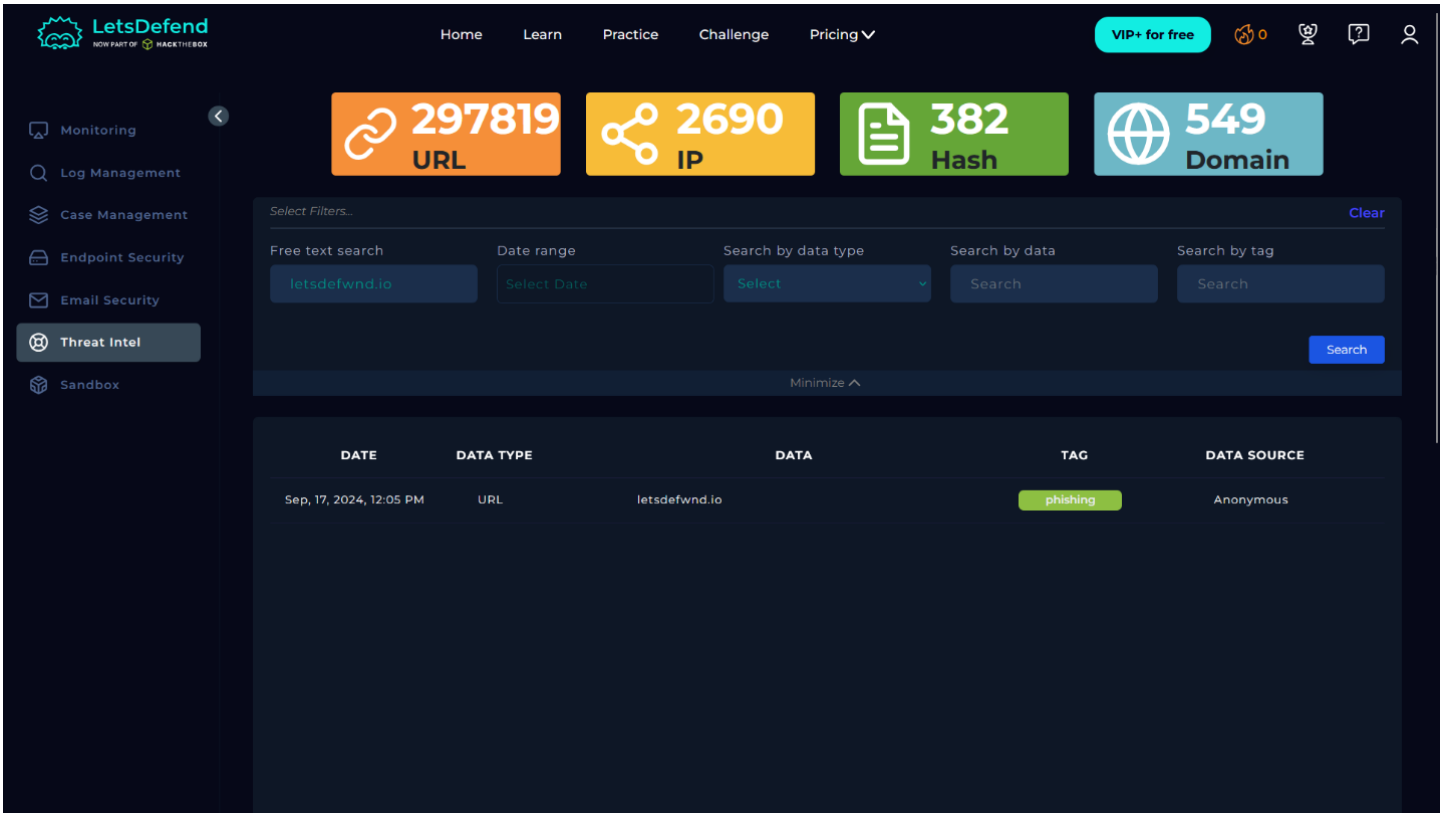
Trigger Reason: Suspicious MX record change on potential phishing domain

Device Action: Allowed

[Domain Information]

Malicious Domain: letsdefwnd.io

MX Record: mail.mailerhost.net



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3. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

[Attacker Infrastructure]

Domain:

- letsdefwnd.io

- http://www.letsdefwnd.io/

Attacker IP:

- 45.33.23.183

Attacker Email:

- voucher@letsdefwnd.io

[Internal Assets]

Compromised Endpoint IP:

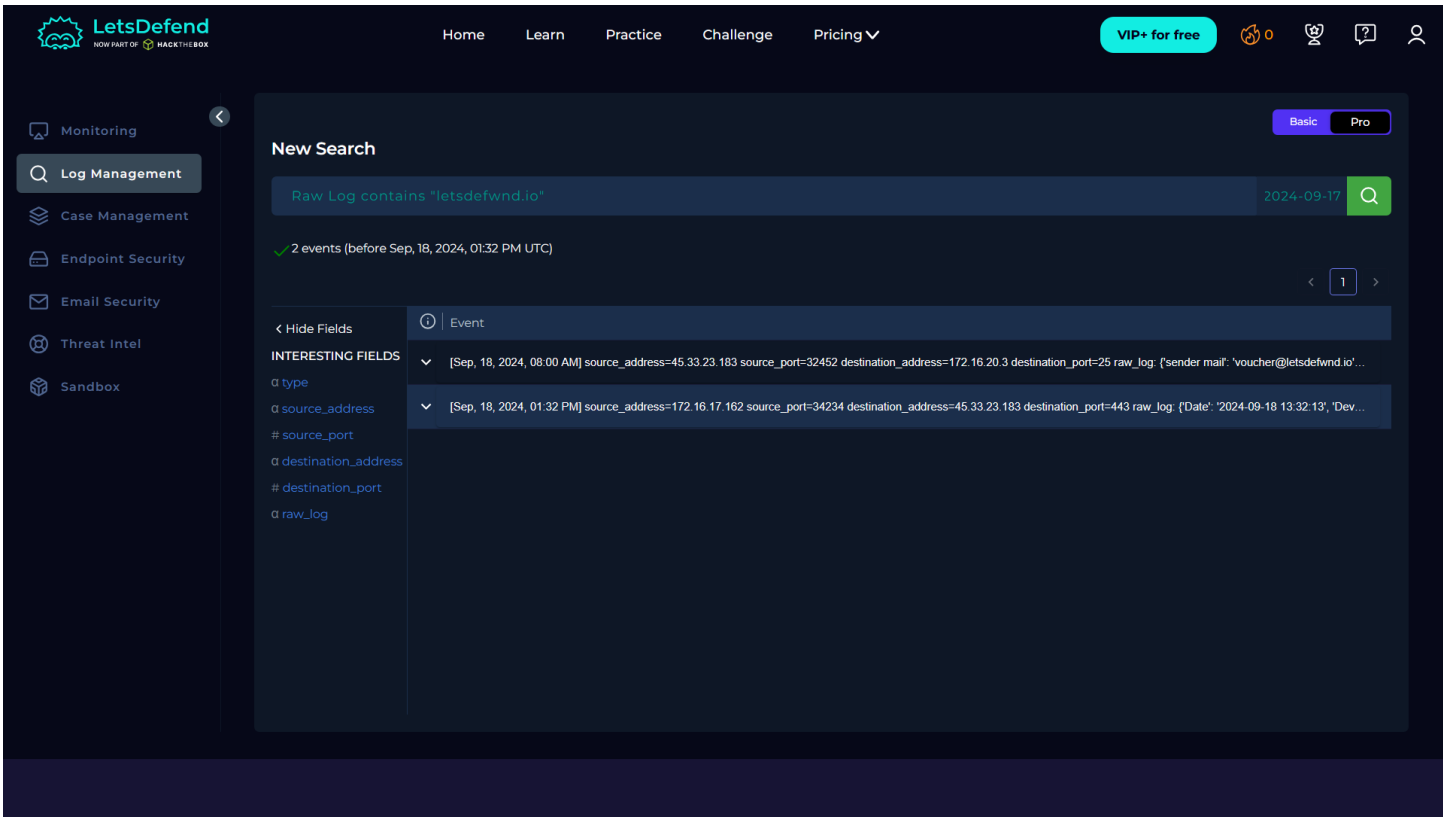
- 172.16.17.162

Hostname:

- Mateo

Mail Server:

- 172.16.20.3



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4. Attack Lifecycle Analysis (Cyber Kill Chain)

[Phase 1: Weaponization / Infrastructure Setup]

- Domain letsdefwnd.io registered as typosquatted domain

- MX record configured (mail.mailerhost.net)

- Threat Intel classification: Phishing

Conclusion:

Attacker prepared infrastructure for phishing campaign.

[Phase 2: Delivery]

- Inbound SMTP connection observed
- Source IP: 45.33.23.183
- Source Port: 32452
- Destination IP: 172.16.20.3 (Exchange Server)
- Destination Port: 25 (SMTP)

Email Details:

Sender: voucher@letsdefwnd.io

Conclusion:

Phishing email successfully delivered into internal environment.

[Phase 3: User Interaction]

- Endpoint: Mateo (172.16.17.162)
- Timestamp: September 18, 2024 – 01:32 PM

Browser Activity:

Visited URL:

http://www.letsdefwnd.io/

Conclusion:

User clicked phishing link → confirmed interaction.

[Phase 4: Actions on Objectives]

- Outbound connection initiated from endpoint
- Source IP: 172.16.17.162
- Destination IP: 45.33.23.183
- Destination Port: 443 (HTTPS)

Conclusion:

- Encrypted communication established
- Possible:
  * Credential harvesting
  * Malware delivery

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app.letsdefend.io/logmanagement/logs?ui=pro

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- Email Security
- Threat Intel
- Sandbox

Raw Log contains "letsdefwnd.io" 2024-09-17

2 events (before Sep, 18, 2024, 01:32 PM UTC)

Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

- a type
- a source_address
- # source_port
- a destination_address
- # destination_port
- a raw_log

Event

[Sep, 18, 2024, 08:00 AM] source_address=45.33.23.183 source_port=32452 destination_address=172.16.20.3 destination_port=25 raw_log: {'sender mail': 'voucher@letsdefwnd.io'...

Field	Value
type	Exchange
source_address	45.33.23.183
source_port	32452
destination_address	172.16.20.3
destination_port	25
time	Sep, 18, 2024, 08:00 AM
Raw Log	
sender mail	voucher@letsdefwnd.io

1 row selected

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voucher@letsdefwnd.io OR Detailed Search

Date	Sender	Recipients	Subject	Final Action
Aug, 15, 2025, 04:40 AM	2constheatcomshirl@seznam.cz	stewart@letsdefend.io	Experienced Web3 Developer – CV Att...	Allowed
Mar, 20, 2025, 01:22 PM	michael.johnson@pm.me	Cooper@letsdefend.io	Secure Copy of 2025 Annual Report – ...	Allowed
Mar, 13, 2025, 09:44 AM	update@windows-update.site	dylan@letsdefend.io	Upgrade your system to Windows 11 P...	Allowed
Mar, 06, 2025, 07:15 AM	trevorgreer9312@gmail.com	ellen@letsdefend.io	Invitation: Coinbase Crypto Trader Hiri...	Allowed
Feb, 04, 2025, 05:12 AM	projectmanagement@pm.me	Austin@letsdefend.io	Important: Action Required for Upco...	Allowed
Oct, 21, 2024, 10:21 AM	support@appofficedrive.com	brendan@letsdefend.io	The Latest Update	Allowed
Oct, 15, 2024, 09:29 AM	dawid.tomaszewski@resetlocations.c...	ricky@letsdefend.io	Urgent: Chrome Security Update - Act...	Allowed

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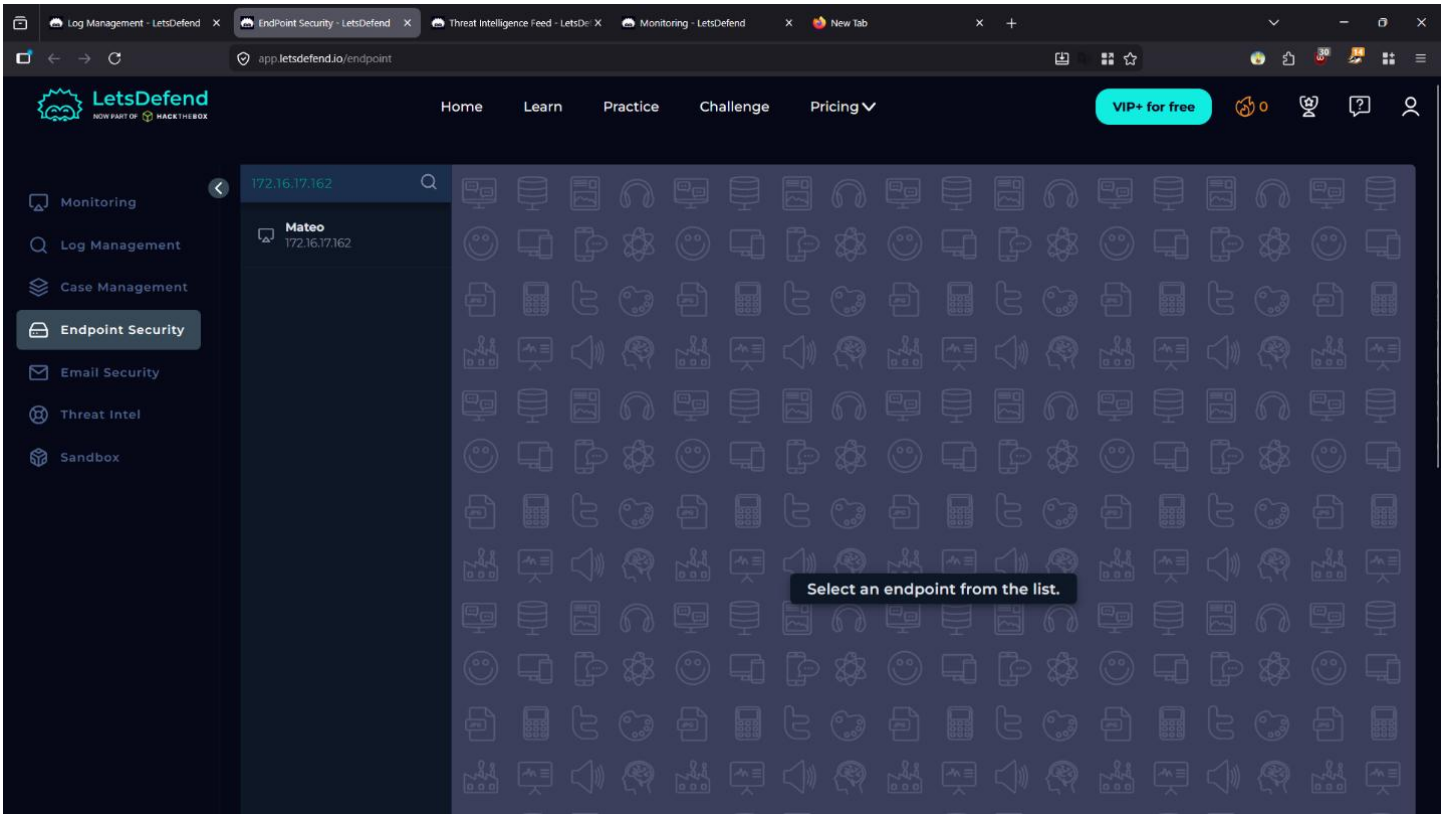
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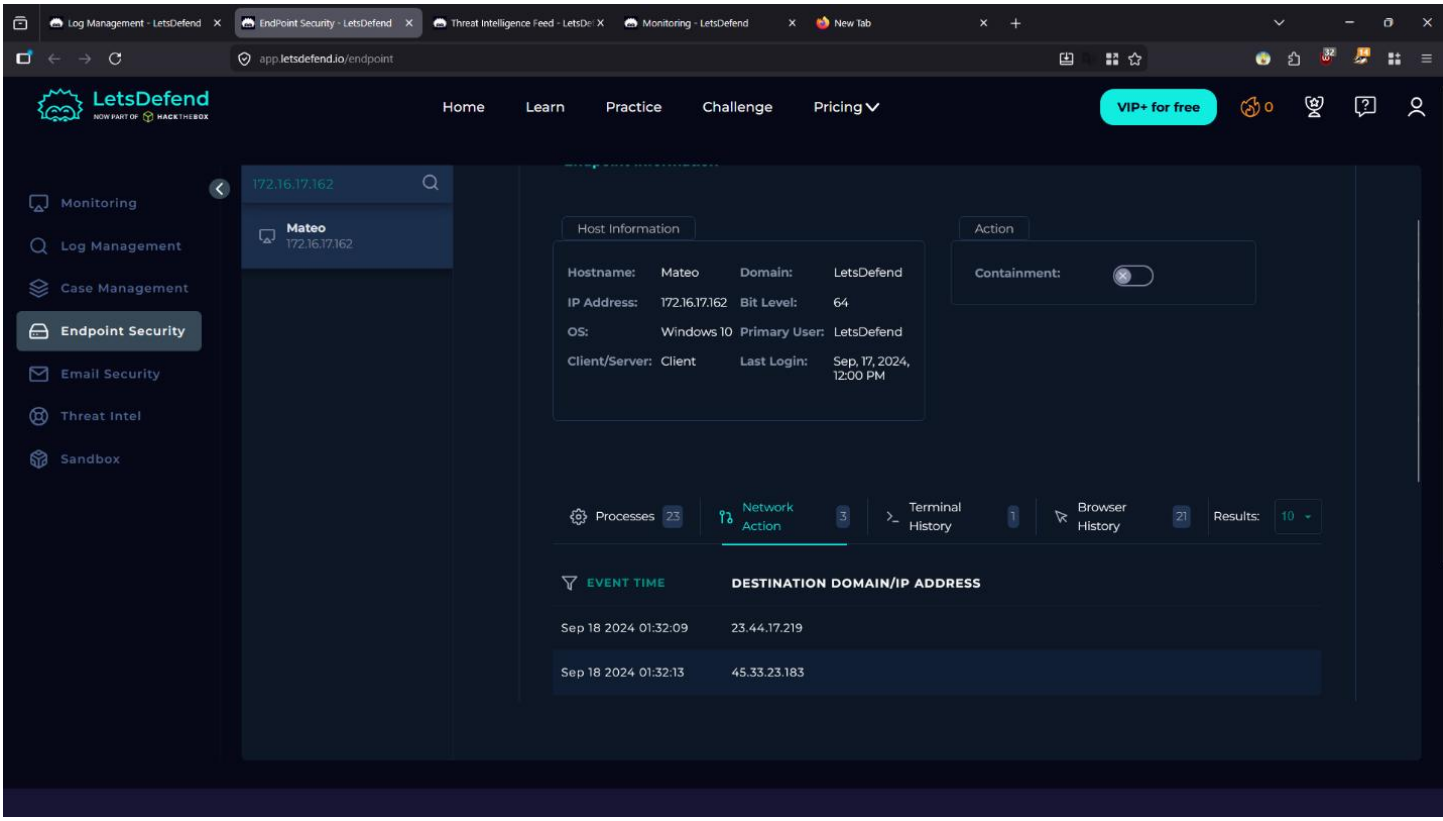
Email Security
Threat Intel
Sandbox
172.16.17.162
Mateo
172.16.17.162
Select an endpoint from the list.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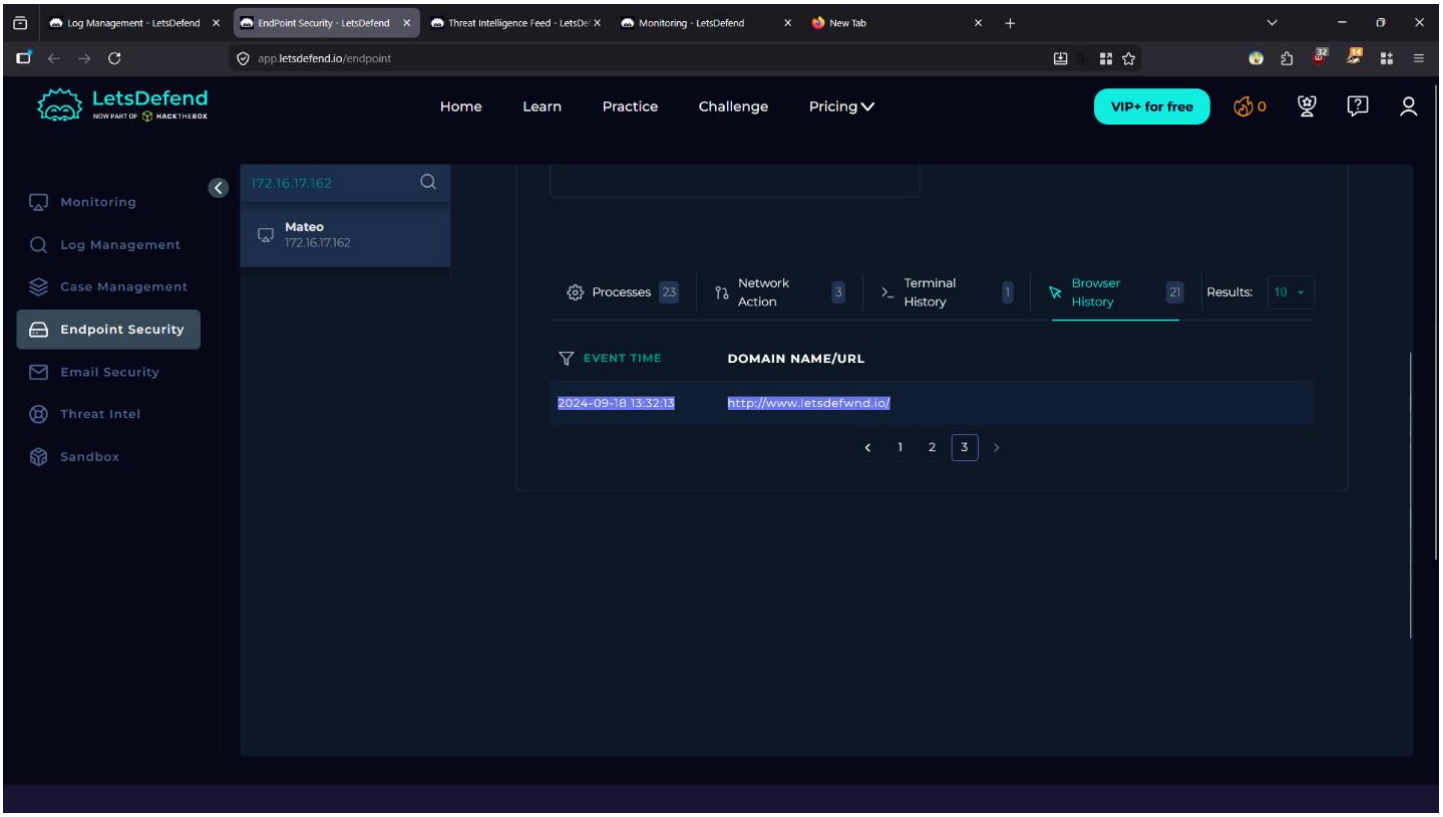
Email Security
Threat Intel
Sandbox
172.16.17.162
Mateo
172.16.17.162
Host Information
Hostname: Mateo
Domain: LetsDefend
IP Address: 172.16.17.162
Bit Level: 64
OS: Windows 10
Primary User: LetsDefend
Client/Server: Client
Last Login: Sep, 17, 2024, 12:00 PM
Action
Containment:
Processes 23
Network Action 3
Terminal History 1
Browser History 21
Results: 10
EVENT TIME
DESTINATION DOMAIN/IP ADDRESS
Sep 18 2024 01:32:09
23.44.17.219
Sep 18 2024 01:32:13
45.33.23.183



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5. Incident Classification

Type: Phishing Attack

Vector: Typosquatting Domain + Email

Technique: Credential Harvesting / Possible Malware Delivery

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping:

T1566 - Phishing

T1583.001 - Acquire Infrastructure (Domains)

T1204 - User Execution

T1071.001 - Application Layer Protocol (HTTPS)

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6. Impact Assessment

[Risk Factors]

- Email bypassed security controls
- User interaction confirmed
- Outbound connection to malicious IP
- Encrypted communication (HTTPS)

[Potential Impact]

- Credential compromise
- Unauthorized access
- Malware infection
- Data exfiltration

Impact Level: Critical

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7. Response Actions

[Immediate Containment]

- Isolated endpoint: Mateo (172.16.17.162)
- Blocked active network connections

[Credential Security]

- Forced password reset for affected user
- Revoked all active sessions (AD, O365, internal systems)

[Eradication]

- Removed phishing emails from all inboxes
- Conducted full EDR and antivirus scan on endpoint

[Prevention / Hardening]

- Blocked domain: letsdefwnd.io
- Blocked IP: 45.33.23.183
- Updated firewall and SWG policies

[Detection Improvement]

- Enhanced SEG rules:
  * Detect newly registered domains (NRDs)
  * Detect typosquatting (Levenshtein similarity)

[Security Awareness]

- Conducted targeted phishing awareness training
- Focus areas:
  * Domain verification
  * Typosquatting detection
  * Safe link handling

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8. Lessons Learned

- Email filtering requires enhancement
- Need better detection for lookalike domains
- User awareness remains critical defense layer
- Importance of endpoint telemetry correlation

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9. Final Verdict

True Positive – Confirmed Phishing Compromise

This incident demonstrates a complete phishing attack lifecycle:

- Infrastructure setup
- Email delivery
- User interaction

- External communication

Immediate response actions successfully contained the threat and reduced further risk.

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END OF REPORT

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